

Installing the GUIDE Plugin or Skill in Claude

Purpose: Use this reference guide to install the GUIDE plugin on Claude Desktop or the GUIDE Skill on claude.ai.

Once installed, you can evaluate or design instructional content grounded in learning science - right from your Claude conversation. GUIDE scores artifacts across 60 theory-backed dimensions, flags issues, and suggests improvements so your courses, assessments, and media hold up under scrutiny.



Plugin vs Skills

In the Claude ecosystem, skills are custom procedural instructions, much like individual recipes or pre-built system prompts, that teach Claude how to perform a specific task.

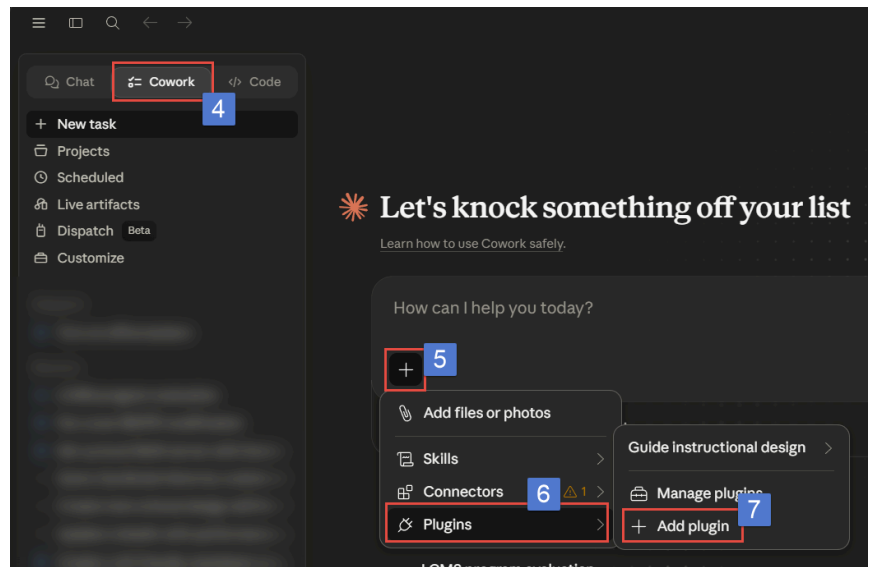
Plugins are distributable packages, more like a cookbook, that bundle multiple skills, commands, tools, subagents, and API connections into a single installable unit.

Which Path is Right for Me?

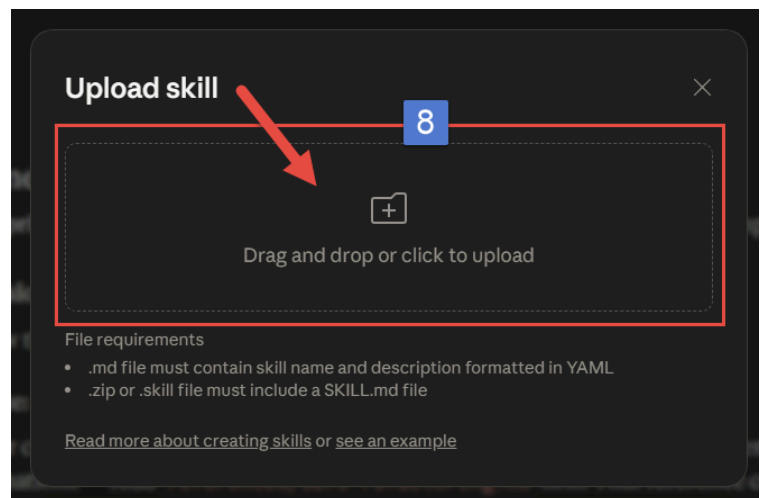
If you use..	Install the...	Jump to...
Claude Desktop (Cowork)	GUIDE Plugin (.plugin file)	Page 2
Claude.ai (web browser)	GUIDE Skill (.skill file)	Page 4

Install GUIDE Plugin in Claude Cowork

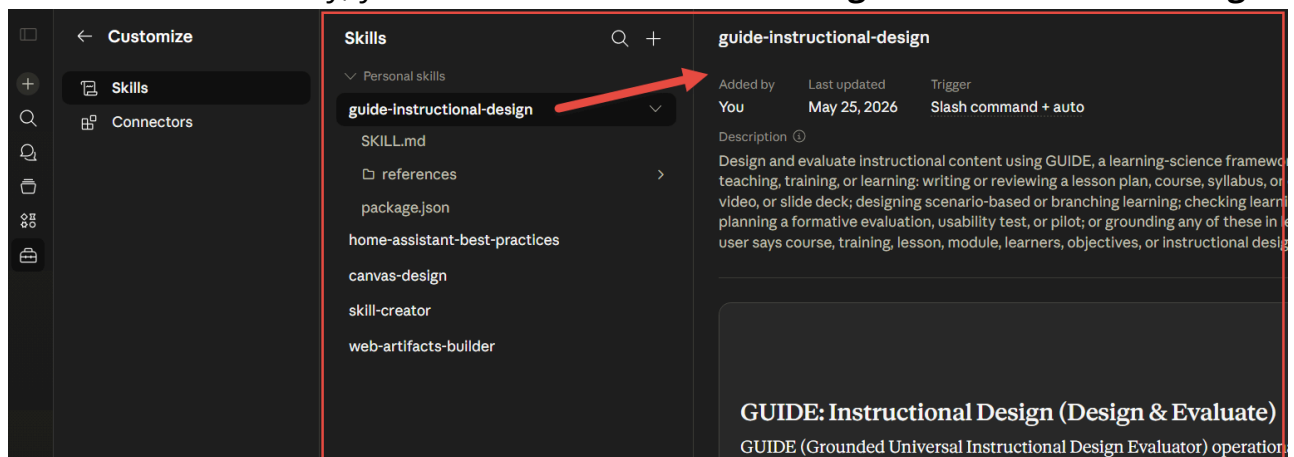
1. Sign in or sign up for [Claude Pro or Claude Max](#).
2. Download and install [Claude Desktop](#).
3. Download the [GUIDE plugin](#).
4. Select **Cowork**.
5. Select **+**
6. Select **Plugins**.
7. Select **Add plugin**.



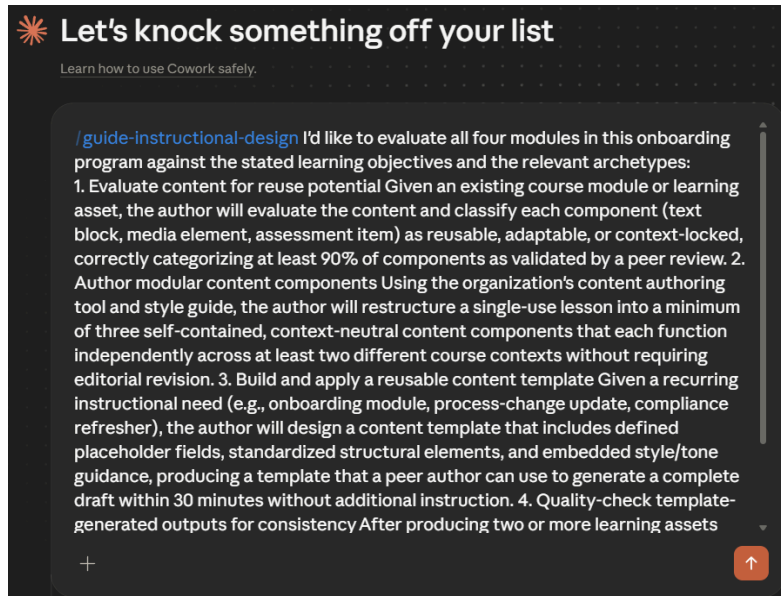
8. Drag and drop or select the **guide-instructional-design.plugin**.



9. If installed successfully, you should see a new skill called **guide-instructional-design**.

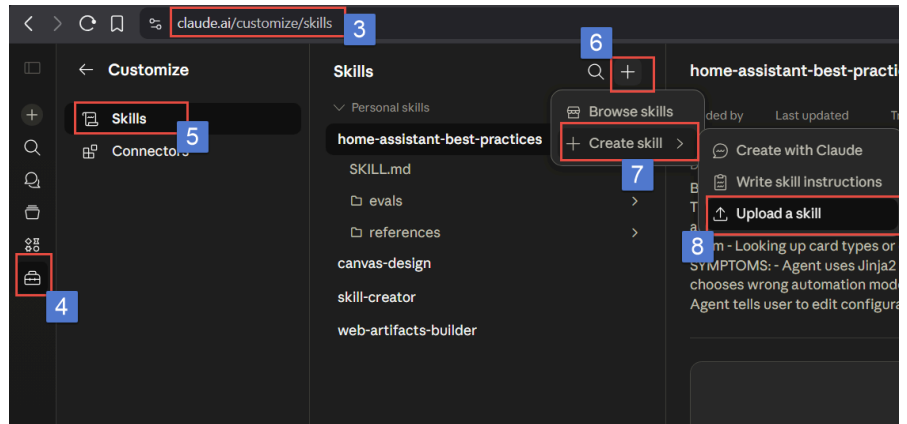


10. To use, open a new Cowork conversation and type ***/guide-instructional-design*** followed by your request to evaluate or create content.

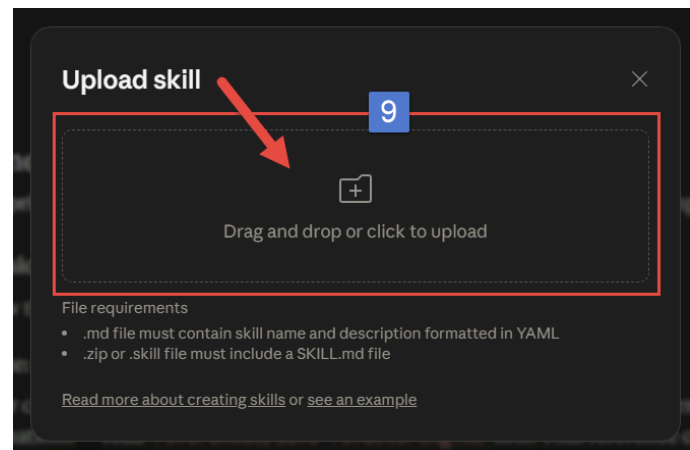


Install GUIDE Skill in Claude.ai

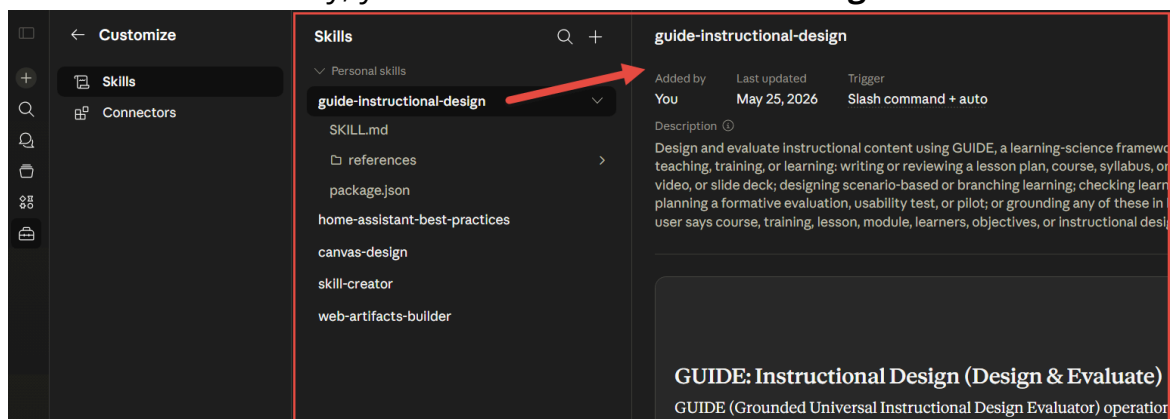
1. Sign in or sign up for [Claude Pro or Claude Max](#).
2. Download the [GUIDE skill](#).
3. Access [Claude.ai](#).
4. Select **Customize**.
5. Select **Skills**.
6. Select **+**.
7. Hover over **Create a Skill**.
8. Select **Upload a skill**.



9. Drag and drop or select the **guide-instructional-design.skill**.



10. If installed successfully, you should see a new skill called **guide-instructional-design**.



11. To use, open a new Claude.ai conversation and type ***/guide-instructional-design*** followed by your request to evaluate or create content.

